



PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

STABLE HAND Rajni Hasija,
Former CMD, IRCTC

➤ On the Right Track

❶ Rajni Hasija took additional charge as Chairperson and MD of IRCTC in February 2021 and superannuated on May 31, 2023

❷ She worked on a number of measures to shore up IRCTC's revenues when the pandemic brought railway ticketing, catering and tourism to a near halt

❸ Ensuring high quality services to win back the trust of passengers while ensuring profitability for investors was a key focus for her

❹ Under Hasija, IRCTC posted its highest ever revenue from operations at ₹3,541.47 crore in FY23

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train side vending (TSV). Its 16 Rail Neer plants produced 357.7 million bottles last fiscal and produce an average of 1.2 million litres of Rail Neer bottles per day. In the tourism business, it operated 140 chartered trains, and 91,555 passengers used its tour packages last fiscal.

For Hasija, the first few months after joining were a challenge, as the pandemic was at its peak and train travel and tourism had come to a grinding halt during the lockdown. Hasija remembers spending much of that time ensuring that passengers were refunded for their train tickets and that community kitchens and Shramik trains to transport migrant labourers operated efficiently.

But as a listed entity, profitability and revenue continued to be key focus areas, and slowly, as train travel resumed and the tourism sector got back on the recovery path, reclaiming the trust of passengers and convincing them to come back was the main priority.

Since railway ticketing was yet to pick up and full-fledged catering in trains only resumed from November-December 2021, IRCTC took that time to get its staff trained in safety standards through Bureau Veritas (a French firm specialising in testing and inspection), technical service provider TUV-Nord, and the Ashok Institute of Hospitality and Tourism Manage-